James Okafor

Senior Backend Systems Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer with 5+ years of experience designing fault-tolerant distributed backends, RESTful APIs, and event-driven data streaming pipelines. Deep technical expertise in Python (FastAPI, Django), PostgreSQL optimization, Apache Kafka message queues, and AWS Kubernetes infrastructure.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Core Technologies: Python, FastAPI, Django, PostgreSQL, Redis, Apache Kafka, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS

Architecture: Microservices, Distributed Systems, Event-Driven Architecture, REST API Design, GraphQL

DevOps & Quality: CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Jenkins), Terraform, Pytest, Linux Administration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Developer — Nexus Pay Systems

2021 – Present (3 years)

- Engineered asynchronous payment ingestion pipeline using FastAPI, Kafka, and Redis caching serving 800 req/sec.
- Optimized PostgreSQL query performance and indexed complex schema migrations, reducing P95 latency by 42%.
- Managed AWS EKS Kubernetes clusters and authored Infrastructure as Code via Terraform.

Backend Software Developer — Helios Cloud Networks

2019 – 2021 (2 years)

- Built secure REST APIs in Python/Django integrated with Stripe and PayPal billing gateways.
- Configured CI/CD automated test pipelines in Jenkins reducing deployment cycle times by 35%.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science — University of Lagos, 2019